

# Notice to Readers

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**– Kiatnakin Phatra Securities Public Company Limited**

## Asia Fund Manager Survey

## Tech Hardware rises; Indonesia slips

## BofA June Asia Fund Manager Survey

**Spotlight:** Energy security concerns have eased significantly, with respondents saying high/extreme concern falling to 18% in Jun (vs. 91% in Apr), while moderate concern has become the majority view (68%). Reflecting this shift, growth and earnings expectations strengthened further in June. Notably, 41% of respondents remain unhedged against downside risk in the AI trade.

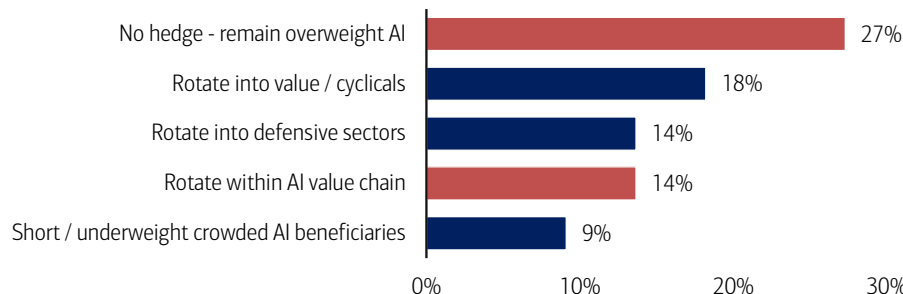
**Expected Returns:** expected 12-month returns for APAC equities moderated following last month's improvement but remain broadly in line with historical norms. AI upside still appears underappreciated, with only 9% of FMS investors believing the positive impact of AI on equities is more than fully priced in.

**Themes:** Earnings are increasingly viewed as key driver for Japan equities, rising to 41% in Jun, while policy normalization has also gained traction (27%). Taiwan (41%) remains the clear beneficiary of the AI cycle, while the US saw increased interest, rising from 10% in May to 18% in Jun.

**Positioning:** Indonesia has overtaken India as investors' least preferred market, while North Asia remains the clear favorite. In APAC ex Japan, FMS investors are now more overweight Tech Hardware than Semiconductors, with Financial Services emerging as a new favored sector. June also saw rotation out of Materials and Consumer Discretionary (ex Retailing) into Financial Services and Telecom. In Japan, Tech Hardware (41%) has risen to tie with Banks as the second-most preferred sector, after Semiconductors.

#### Exhibit 1: Investors are split on de-risking the AI trade, with 41% remaining unhedged and another 41% rotating into other sectors or underweighting

How are you currently hedging downside risk in the AI trade over the next 6-12 months?



Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Notes: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above.

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FMS: Fund Manager Survey  
APAC: Asia Pacific

#### Notes to readers

A total of 198 panelists with \$540bn AUM participated in the May survey. 172 participants with \$465bn AUM responded to the Global FMS questions and 99 participants with \$270bn AUM responded to the Regional FMS questions.

Survey period: 5 Jun – 11 Jun 2026

#### How to join the FMS panel

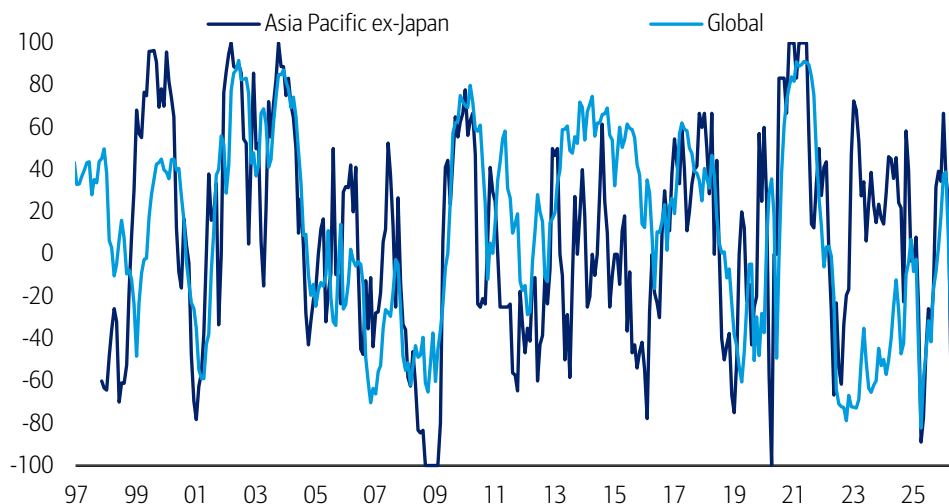
Investors/clients are encouraged to sign up to participate in the Survey. This can be done by contacting [Michael Hartnett](#) or your BofA sales representative.

Participants in the survey receive the full set of results for the months in which they participate.

# Macro

## Exhibit 2: APAC ex-Japan growth expectations turned positive in June, marking a continued recovery from April's sharp downturn

Net % expecting a stronger Global / APAC ex-Japan economy



Source: BofA Global & Asia Fund Manager Survey

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## Exhibit 3: Inflation expectations remain elevated but eased in June, though still sitting well above the long-term average

Net % expecting higher inflation in Asia Pacific ex-Japan in the next 12 months



Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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#### Exhibit 4: Corporate profit expectations strengthened further in June, well above the long-run average

Net % expecting better corporate profits in Asia Pacific ex-Japan in the next 12 months

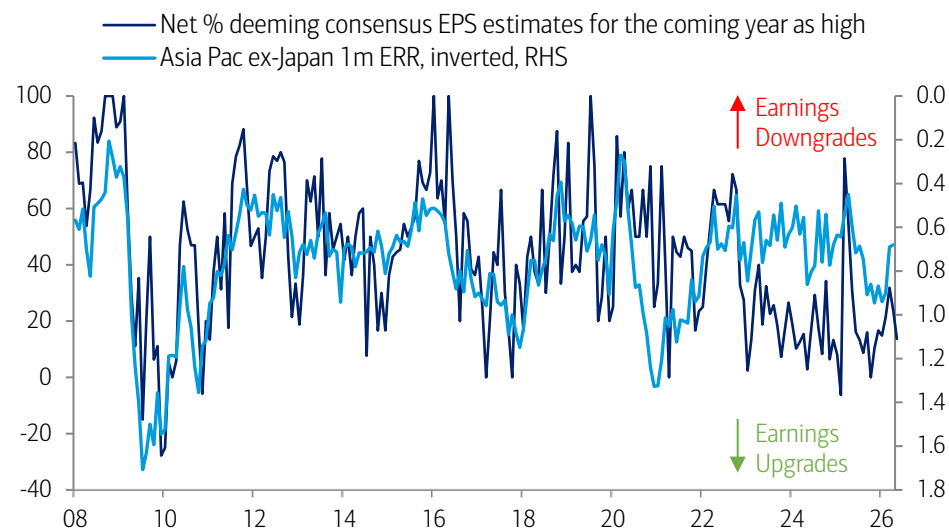


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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#### Exhibit 5: Concern that APAC ex-Japan earnings estimates are too high continue to fade in June, now at 14th percentile historically

Net % deeming consensus EPS estimates for the coming year as high

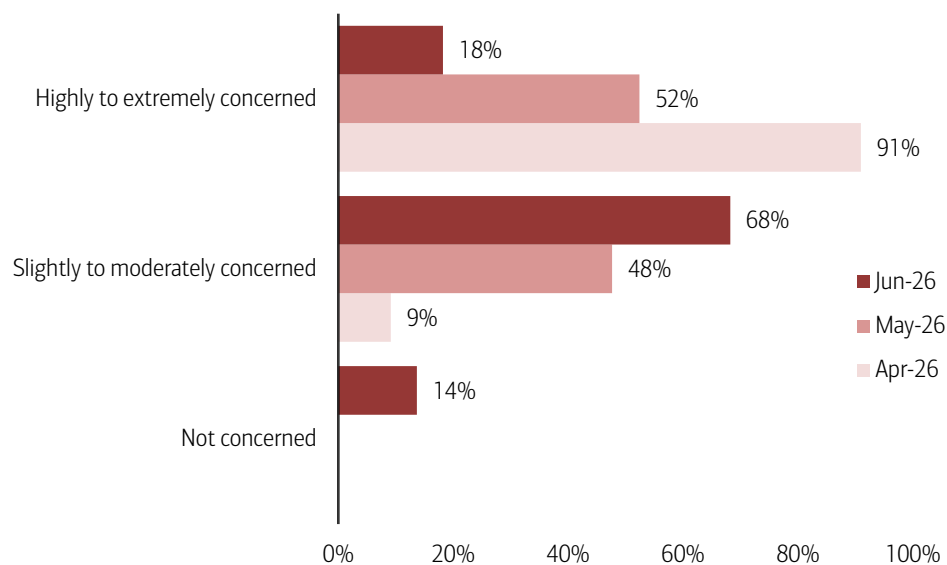


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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### Exhibit 6: Energy security concerns have normalized: high/extreme concern dropped 73pts since Apr, while moderate concern became the majority view

How concerned are you about energy security risks for APAC region in current geopolitical environment?

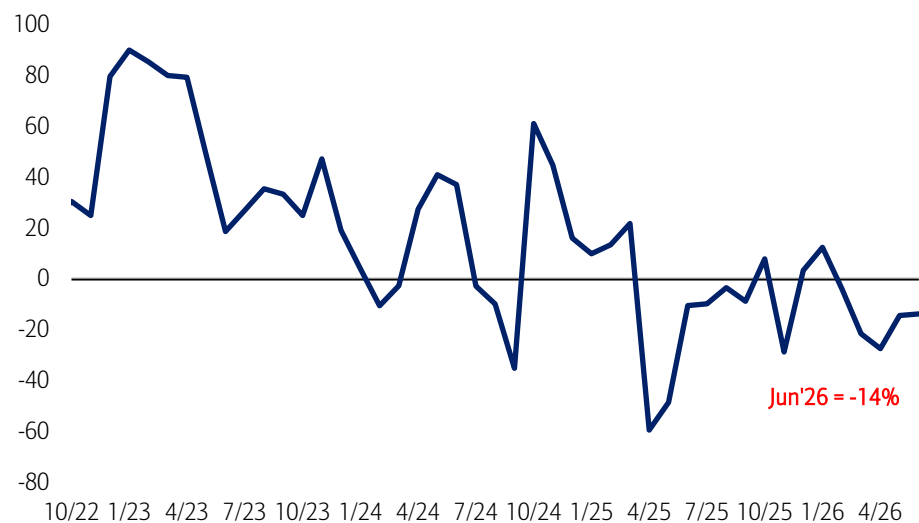


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Notes: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above.

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### Exhibit 7: China growth sentiment remains negative, with net reading unchanged at -14% vs. May

Net % expecting a stronger Chinese economy in the next 12 months



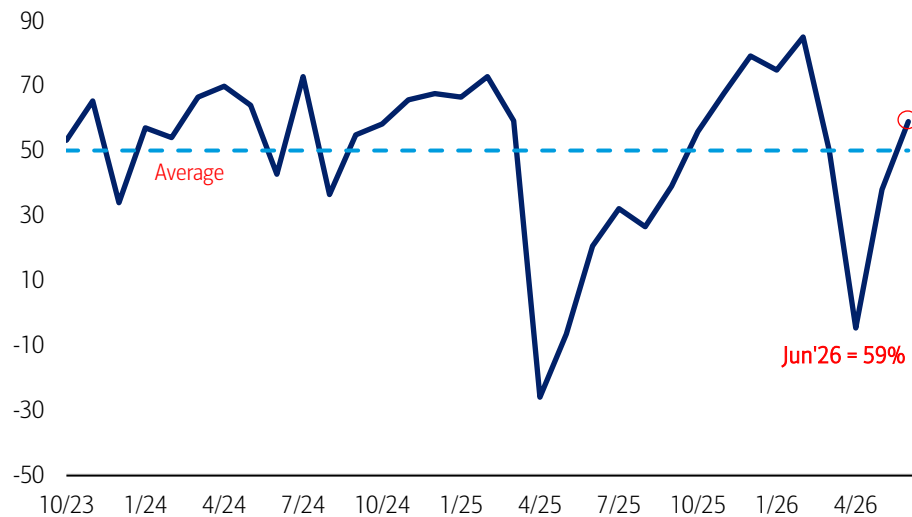
Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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**Exhibit 8: Japan growth expectations improved further in June, surpassing the long-term average**

Net % expecting a stronger Japanese economy over the next 12 months

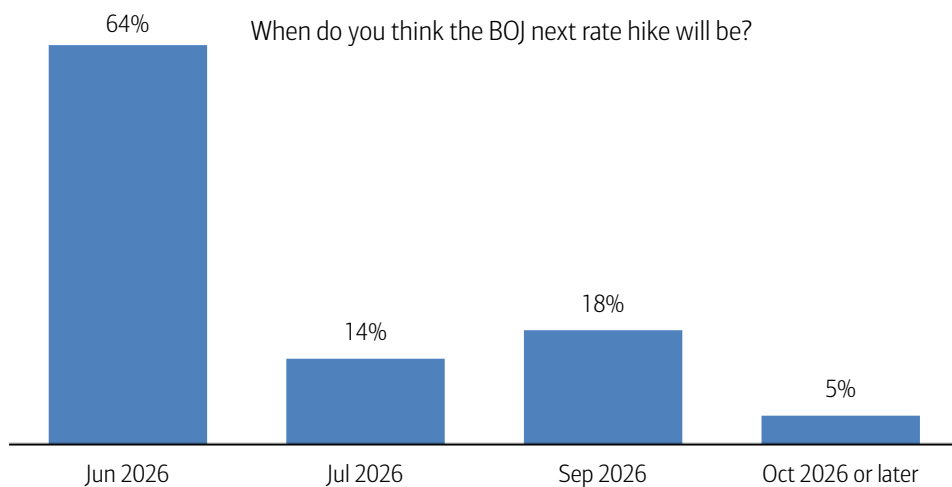


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Notes: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above.

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**Exhibit 9: Investors expect the next rate hike to be most likely in Jun**

When do you think the BOJ next rate hike will be?



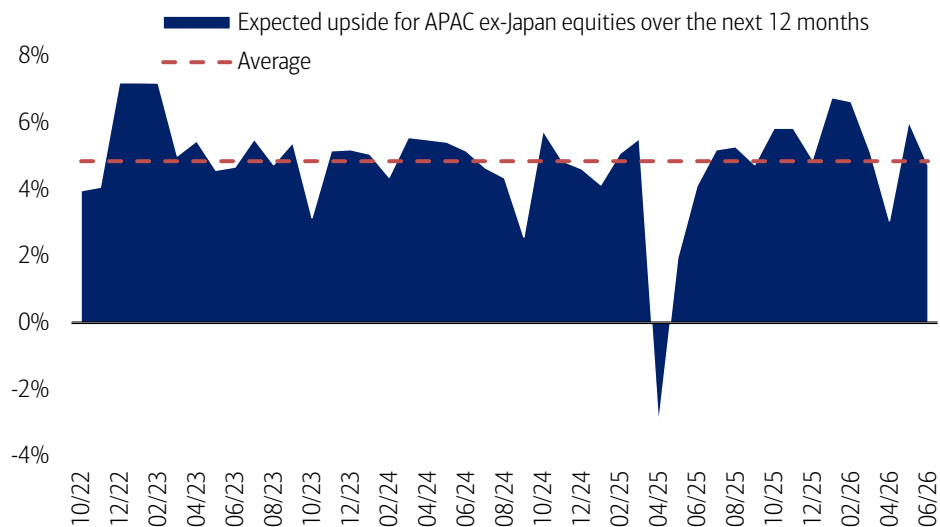
Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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## Expected Returns and Valuations

### Exhibit 10: Investor optimism cooled after last month's improvement but remains broadly in line with historical norms

FMS views on expected upside for Asia Pac ex-Japan equities over the next 12 months



Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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### Exhibit 11: Similar to Asia ex, optimism in Japan has normalized after last month's peak

FMS views on expected upside for Japan equities over the next 12 months



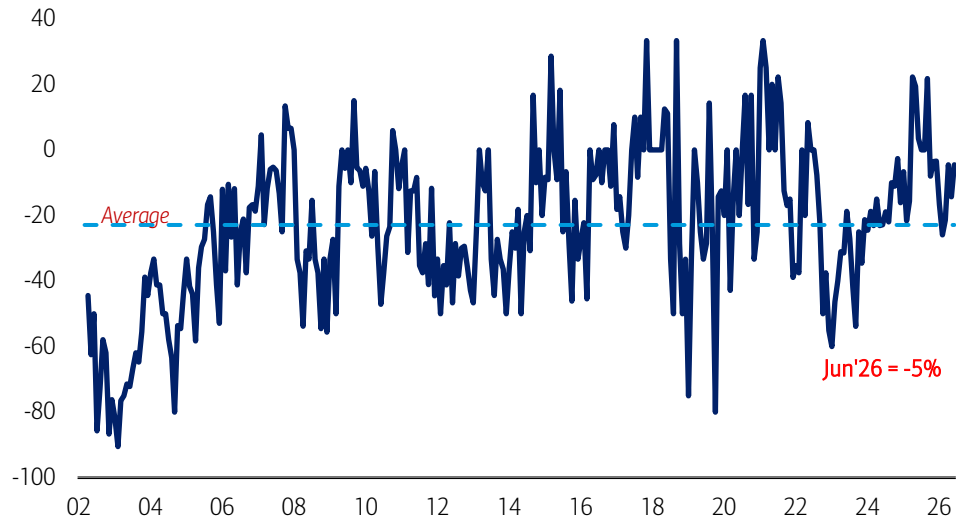
Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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**Exhibit 12: FMS investors still see APAC ex-Japan equities as slightly undervalued**

Net % saying Asia Pacific ex-Japan equities are overvalued

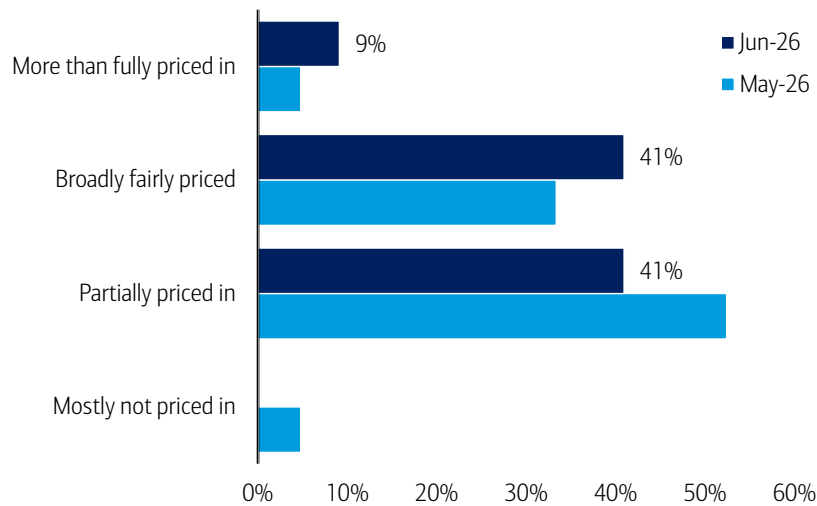


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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**Exhibit 13: AI upside still looks underappreciated. Only 9% of FMS investors say the positive AI impact on equities is more than fully priced in**

How much of the positive AI impact on equities is already reflected in the price?



Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Note: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above

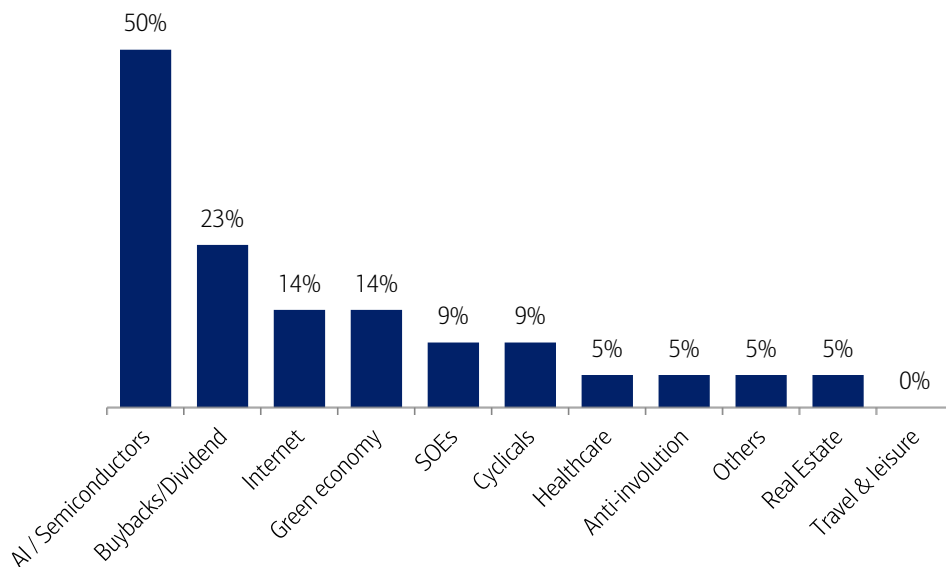
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## Themes

### Exhibit 14: Within China, AI/semis and buybacks/dividend remain key investor priorities

FMS views on TWO most favorite themes in China

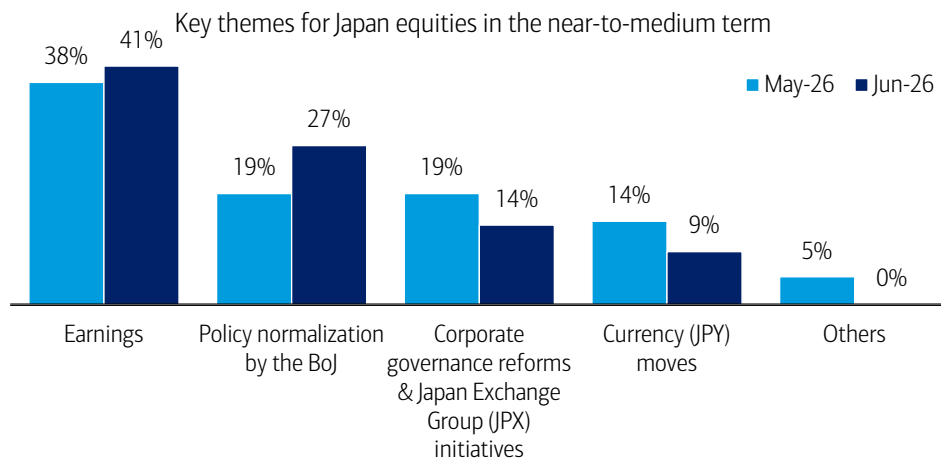


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Note: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above

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### Exhibit 15: Earnings increasingly seen as key driver for Japan equities, rising to 41% in Jun, while policy normalization also gained traction at 27%

FMS views on the themes that hold the key for Japan equities in the near-to-medium term



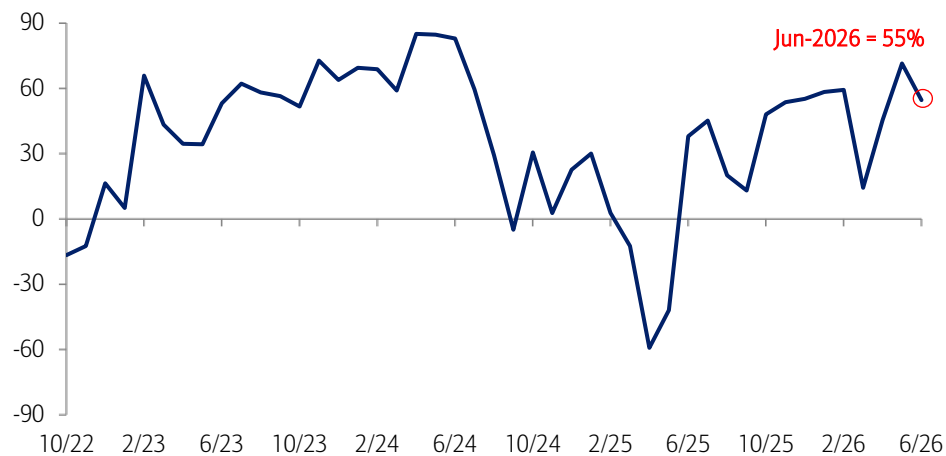
Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Notes: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above

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### Exhibit 16: Investor expectations for the Korea/Taiwan semis cycle eased from May but stay firmly positive in June

FMS views on the semis cycle (Korea/Taiwan exports growth) over the next 12 months

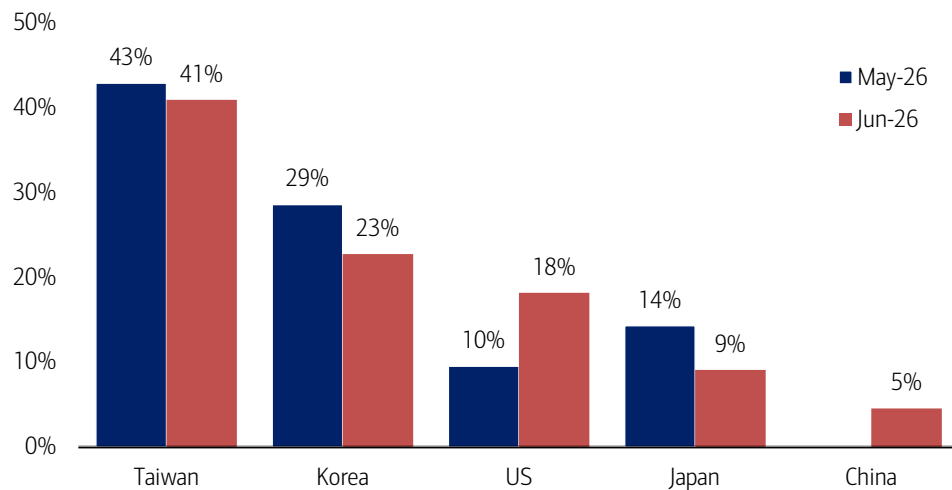


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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### Exhibit 17: Taiwan remains the clear AI-cycle beneficiary, while US gained momentum in Jun

Which market benefits most from the next phase of the AI cycle?

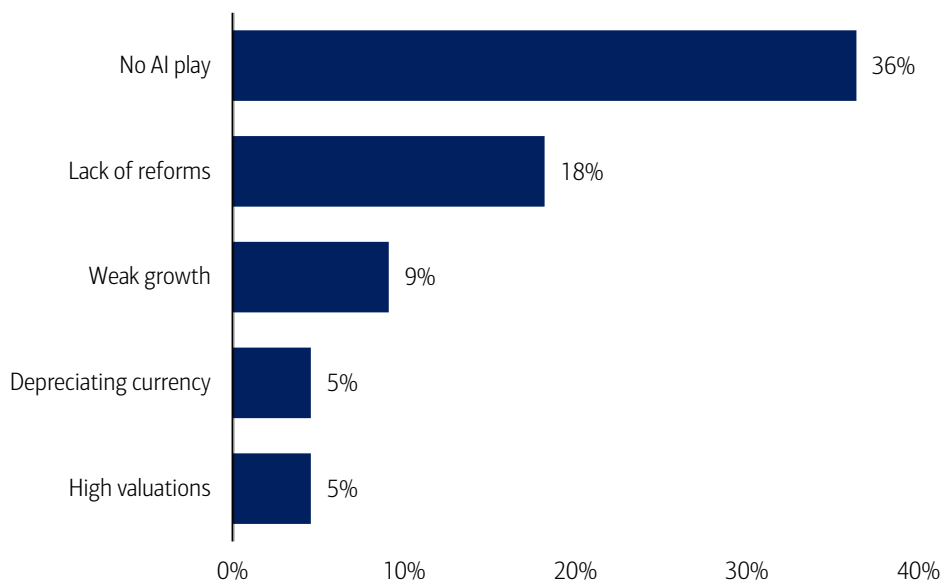


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Note: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above

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**Exhibit 18: The absence of a clear AI play remains the primary concern for the Indian market**

What is your key concern for Indian market?



Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Note: Votes for 'Don't know' are not shown above

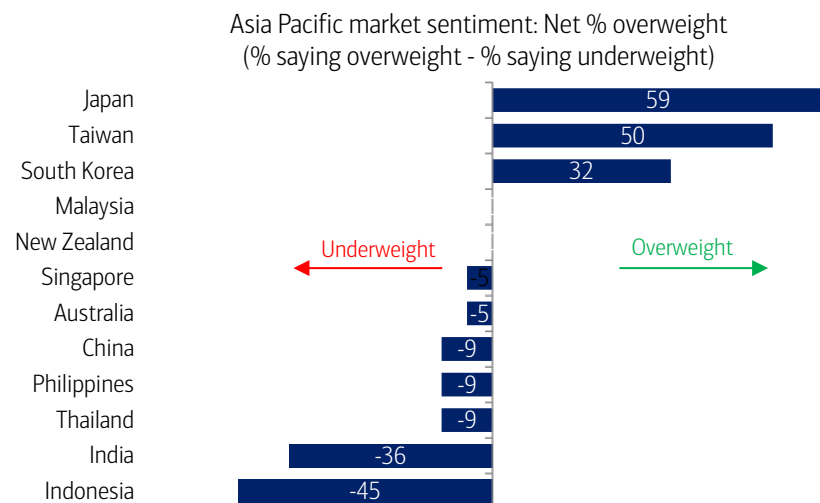
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# Positioning

## Exhibit 19: Indonesia overtook India as investors' least preferred market, while North Asia remains the clear favorite

Asia Pacific market sentiment: Net % overweight

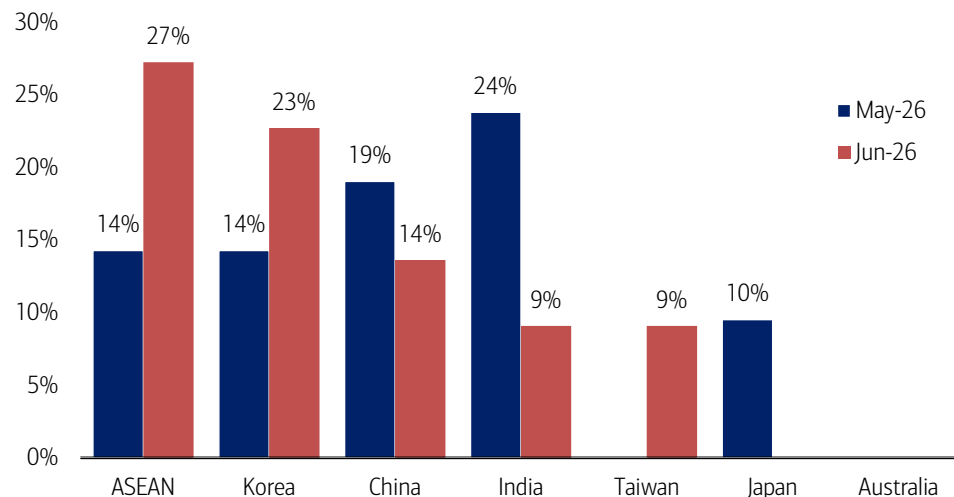


Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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## Exhibit 20: Investors are cautious on ASEAN and Korea in the event of an economic downturn

If global growth weakens further, you would first reduce exposure to...?



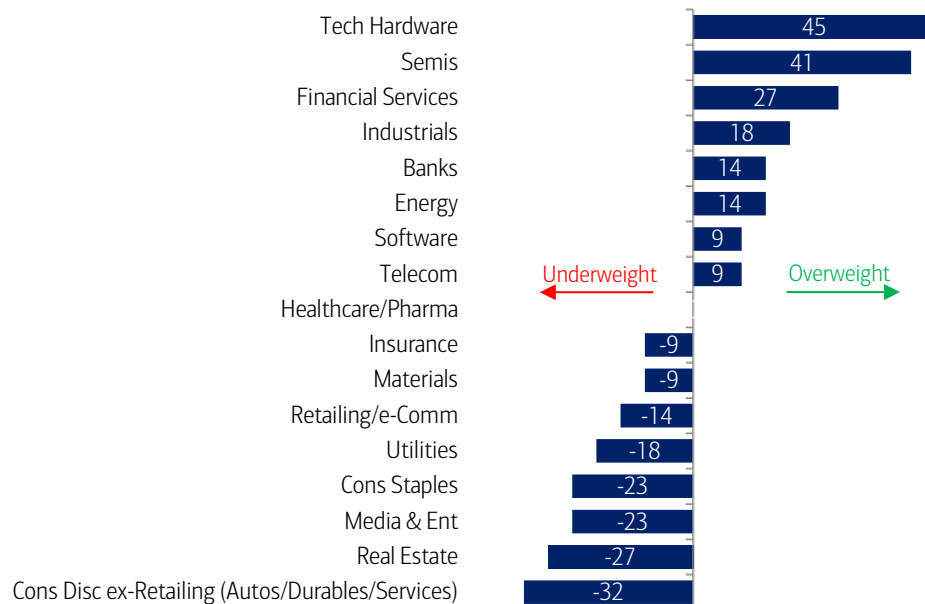
Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey. Note: Votes for 'Don't know / Not applicable' are not shown above

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### Exhibit 21: FMS investors are now more overweight in Tech Hardware than Semis, with Financial Services emerging as a new favored sector

Asia Pacific ex-Japan sector sentiment: Net % overweight

APAC ex-Japan sector sentiment: Net % FMS investors overweight  
(% saying overweight - % saying underweight)



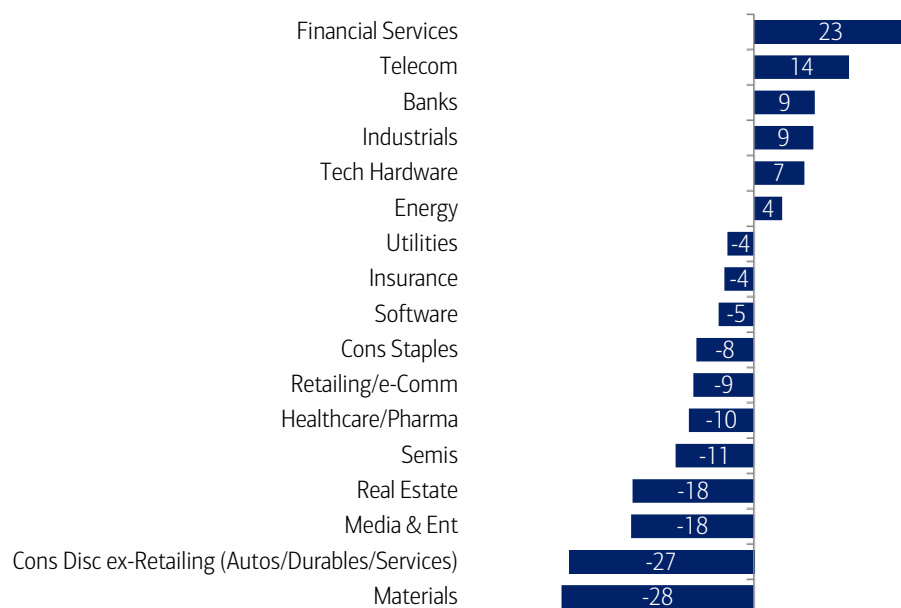
Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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### Exhibit 22: June saw a rotation out of Materials and Consumer Discretionary (ex Retailing) into Financial Services and Telecom

Monthly change in FMS investor positioning

APAC ex-Japan sector sentiment: MoM ppt change in FMS investor positioning



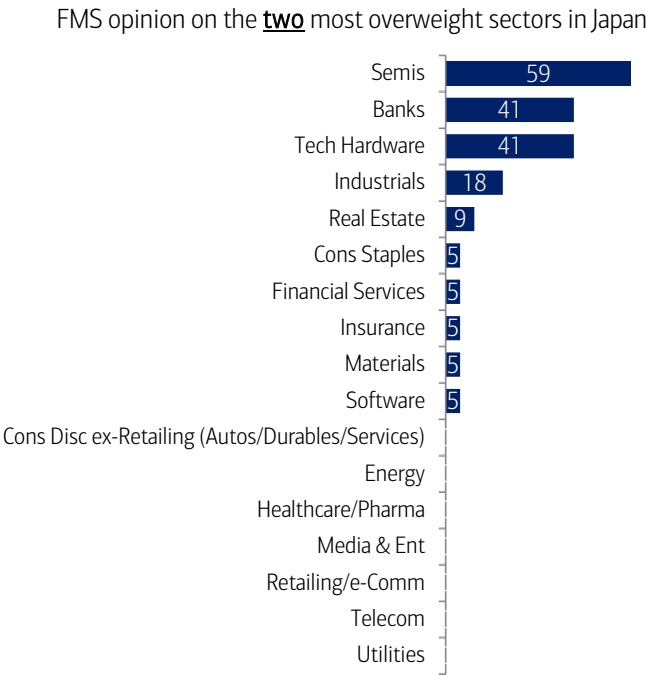
Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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**Exhibit 23: Semiconductors and Banks remain investor favorites in Japan, while Tech Hardware has risen to match Banks**

FMS opinion on the two most overweight sectors in Japan



Source: BofA Asia Fund Manager Survey

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# Regional survey demographics data

## Exhibit 24: Position / institution / approach of participants in the regional survey

Demographics details for regional Fund Manager Survey participants

|                                                                                                | Jun-26     | May-26     | Apr-26     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|------------|
| <b>Structure of the panel - by position</b>                                                    |            |            |            |
| Chief Investment Officer                                                                       | 11         | 11         | 9          |
| Asset Allocator / Strategist / Economist                                                       | 18         | 14         | 17         |
| Portfolio Manager                                                                              | 63         | 60         | 55         |
| Other                                                                                          | 7          | 7          | 9          |
| <b>Structure of the panel - by expertise</b>                                                   |            |            |            |
| Regional specialists + EM specialists only                                                     | 26         | 30         | 23         |
| Regional specialists with a global view                                                        | 73         | 62         | 67         |
| <b>Total # of respondents to regional questions</b>                                            | <b>99</b>  | <b>92</b>  | <b>90</b>  |
| <b>Which of the following best describes the type of money you are running?</b>                |            |            |            |
| Institutional funds (e.g. pension funds / insurance companies)                                 | 27         | 20         | 28         |
| Hedge funds / proprietary trading desks                                                        | 13         | 16         | 11         |
| Mutual funds / unit trusts / investment trusts                                                 | 48         | 45         | 42         |
| None of the above                                                                              | 11         | 11         | 9          |
| <b>What do you estimate to be the total current value of assets under your direct control?</b> |            |            |            |
| Up to \$250mn                                                                                  | 15         | 17         | 15         |
| Around \$500mn                                                                                 | 10         | 13         | 9          |
| Around \$1bn                                                                                   | 21         | 13         | 14         |
| Around \$2.5bn                                                                                 | 16         | 18         | 16         |
| Around \$5bn                                                                                   | 12         | 9          | 11         |
| Around \$7.5bn                                                                                 | 4          | 2          | 4          |
| Around \$10bn or more                                                                          | 11         | 8          | 10         |
| No funds under my direct control                                                               | 10         | 12         | 11         |
| <b>Total (USD bn)</b>                                                                          | <b>270</b> | <b>209</b> | <b>247</b> |
| <b>What best describes your investment time horizon at this moment?</b>                        |            |            |            |
| 3 months or less                                                                               | 34         | 30         | 31         |
| 6 months                                                                                       | 26         | 28         | 16         |
| 9 months                                                                                       | 9          | 7          | 10         |
| 12 months or more                                                                              | 27         | 24         | 30         |
| <b>Weighted average</b>                                                                        | <b>6.9</b> | <b>6.8</b> | <b>7.3</b> |
| Don't know                                                                                     | 3          | 3          | 3          |
| <b>Which region do you specialise in?</b>                                                      |            |            |            |
| US / North America                                                                             | 30         | 24         | 21         |
| Europe / Continental Europe / Eurozone / UK                                                    | 28         | 31         | 24         |
| Asia Pacific / Asia Pacific ex Japan / Japan                                                   | 22         | 21         | 22         |
| South Africa                                                                                   | 14         | 12         | 16         |
| MENA (Middle East and North Africa)                                                            | 0          | 0          | 2          |
| None of the above                                                                              | 5          | 4          | 5          |

Source: BofA Fund Manager Survey

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| Investment rating | Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating) | Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster <sup>R1</sup> |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Buy               | ≥ 10%                                                                       | ≤ 70%                                                            |
| Neutral           | ≥ 0%                                                                        | ≤ 30%                                                            |
| Underperform      | N/A                                                                         | ≥ 20%                                                            |

<sup>R1</sup> Ratings dispersions may vary from time to time where BofA Global Research believes it better reflects the investment prospects of stocks in a Coverage Cluster.

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